and he kept pressing me to fire Ed Meese and other people on the staff whom I thought highly of. And I guess I still hadn't forgiven him for what John had done to Mike Deaver, and so as election day approached, I decided enough was enough.

The morale problem and bickering wasn't our campaign's only problem: We had been spending money at such a rate we were in danger of exceeding limits established by federal election laws, which meant we might not have enough left for important primaries later in the spring.

A change was necessary at the top of the campaign staff. I knew I had to do it before the results were in from New Hampshire because if I lost and then fired Sears, people could say I was trying to make him the scapegoat for my loss, and I didn't want that to happen.

So, on the day that New Hampshire voters were going to the polls, I invited John, Jim Lake, and Charles Black to my hotel room and I asked them to resign. They took it well and I think they understood why the changes were necessary.

I had already asked Bill Casey, a former chairman of the Securities and Exchange Commission whom I'd met while campaigning in New York City, to take over as campaign director, straighten out our finances, and assure we didn't run out of money prematurely; Ed Meese became chief of staff in charge of day-to-day campaign operations; and soon Mike Deaver, Lyn Nofziger, and Martin Anderson rejoined our team. Later on, Stu Spencer also became a part of the leadership group.

Several hours after the meeting in the hotel room, the polls closed and I learned I had won the seven-way New Hampshire primary with fifty-one percent of the vote.

In retrospect, this was really the pivotal day of the whole primary campaign for me. From then on, with the management changes we had made, the campaign ran smoothly and the victory in New Hampshire gave us a